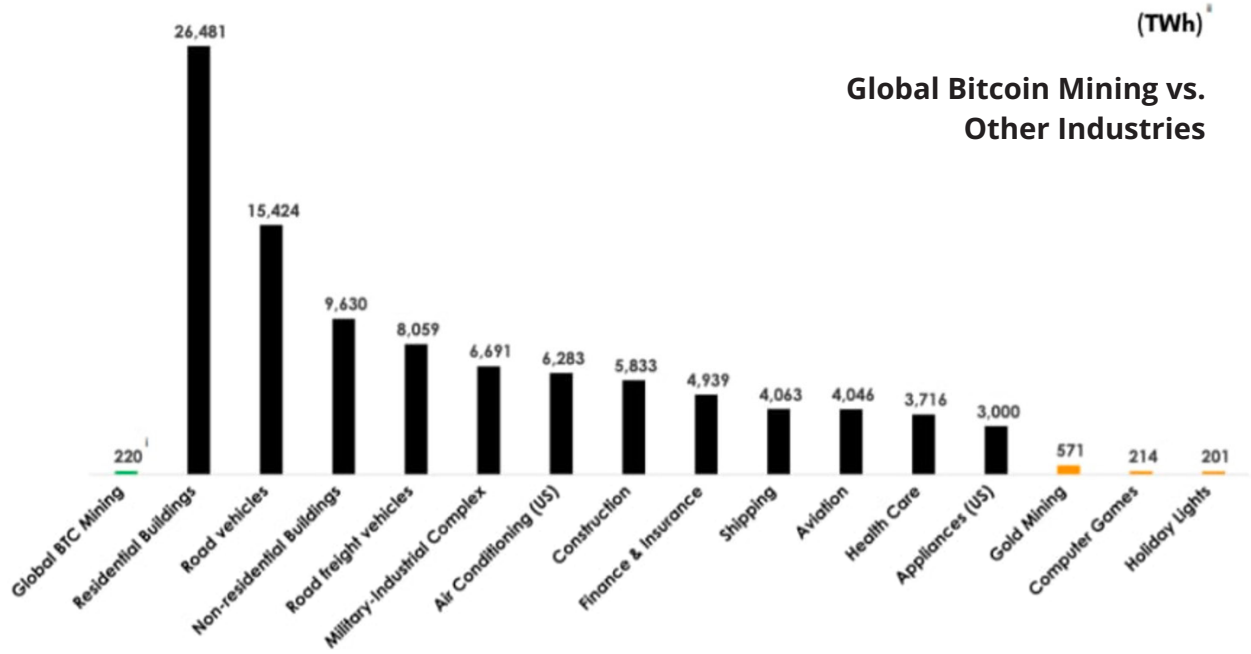
Gary Gensler recently stated that the regulation of the cryptocurrency market is getting closer and that ***Bitcoin*** will be considered a commodity. According to the SEC, many tokens in the market have the key attributes of securities and will fall under the jurisdiction of the SEC, while ***Bitcoin*** falls under the oversight of the Commodity Futures Trading Commission (CFTC) as a commodity. The SEC has work to do to introduce comprehensive laws that protect investors, and this decision by the SEC chair is seen as positive by some investors, leading to the expectation of gradually rising prices. Despite the current market volatility, some investors view this as a buying opportunity and believe in the future of digital currencies as a borderless, decentralized, tamper-proof, and unconfiscatable form of money.

9.3.2 Understanding the Energy Usage of Bitcoin Mining

Bitcoin mining uses a lot of energy, around 79 terawatts-hours per year. However, this does not necessarily mean that it is a waste of energy or harmful to the environment. ***Bitcoin*** mining can help to utilize unused capacity of energy, especially in remote or inaccessible places. Additionally, most Bitcoin mining is done with renewable energy such as hydroelectric, solar, wind, and geothermal. This helps to make the production and research of these energy sources more profitable. Furthermore, Bitcoin mining provides security for the Bitcoin network, enabling people to have access to secure and accessible money.

However, it's important to note that the energy usage is determined by the competition among miners, not the number of transactions. The digital signature validation process, which is a small part of mining, uses minimal energy. The energy usage of ***Bitcoin*** mining is high, but it is not as high as other industries like the traditional financial system or gold mining and recycling. Miners are also increasingly using clean and renewable energy sources like geothermal and hydroelectric power to power their mining operations.